English Orbit

STARTER TO ADVANCED / ALL SIX PARTS

The complete coursebook

A sequential companion to the English Orbit app: 24 lessons, 120 controlled language practice items, 72 reading comprehension questions, six checkpoints and guided practice in five skills.

Inside the book

Start with the alphabet and first everyday phrases. Build simple sentences, describe routines and tell stories. Continue through experiences, arguments, evidence and precise academic or professional expression.

Each lesson has three sections: read and notice; understand and practise; listen, speak and write. Each part ends with answers and review guidance.

Study online or on paper

Open the companion app for speech playback, dictation, speaking tools and device-local progress.

The PDF is a compact original coursebook companion. CEFR labels describe intended language focus; completing this book does not itself certify proficiency. Audio is provided through the app, not embedded in the PDF.

A clear route from the start

Read in order or use the individual part that matches your current focus.

Part 1 / Starter / Pre-A1 / page 3

Build your first sentences. Say hello and describe your world.

Part 2 / Elementary / A1 / page 24

Talk about routines, people, places and everyday needs.

Part 3 / Pre-intermediate / A2 / page 43

Tell stories, make plans and handle everyday situations.

Part 4 / Intermediate / B1 / page 62

Explain experiences, solve problems and give reasons.

Part 5 / Upper-intermediate / B2 / page 81

Discuss ideas, weigh evidence and express nuanced opinions.

Part 6 / Advanced / C1 / page 100

Interpret complex arguments and communicate with precision.

The six parts have their own printed page numbers. This contents page uses the page number shown by your PDF reader. Use the PDF bookmarks to jump to a part.

English Orbit

PART 1 OF 6 / Pre-A1

Starter

Build your first sentences. Say hello and describe your world.

Read. Listen. Write. Speak. Understand.

An original coursebook companion to the interactive English Orbit course. Four connected lessons combine language explanations with practical activities and guided review.

Included in this part: language focus, vocabulary, reading passages, grammar practice, listening scripts, speaking tasks, writing tasks, a level checkpoint and answer keys.

For independent learners, classrooms and teacher-led study. All teaching content is in English.

Use the course alongside the book

Open English Orbit to hear lesson passages and model sentences. Select this level and the matching lesson.

CEFR labels indicate the intended language focus. This compact companion is not a complete CEFR syllabus or an official proficiency qualification.

Your route through this part

Build your first sentences. Say hello and describe your world.

Four lessons, one clear sequence

01 Hello, world | Names & introductions

02 Things around me | A / an & simple nouns

03 My family | Possessives & people

04 A simple day | Basic verbs & time

How to study a lesson

1. Read for the overall meaning. Read again and notice the language focus.
2. Learn the four key words. Make your own example for each word.
3. Complete the reading and grammar practice before checking the answers.
4. Listen without reading first. Write a dictation, then compare it with the script.
5. Speak aloud, record if possible, and reflect on your delivery.
6. Write a response, review it and revise at least one sentence.

> Suggested rhythm: 25-40 minutes in the app, plus 20-30 minutes of book practice per lesson. Take breaks and repeat difficult activities rather than rushing to the next level.

Use a notebook for extended answers. Listening can use the app, a teacher or a study partner. The PDF contains scripts and tasks; it does not contain embedded audio.

For open questions, wording may differ from the sample answers. For speaking and writing, use the review criteria; there is no single correct personal response.

Before lesson one

Your first words and sounds

The alphabet

A B C D E F G H I J K L M
N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z

Letters are not the same as sounds. The vowel letters are A, E, I, O and U. A letter can have different sounds in different words. Listen to the alphabet button in the Starter section, repeat, then spell your name.

Numbers 0-20

0 zero · 1 one · 2 two · 3 three · 4 four · 5 five · 6 six · 7 seven · 8 eight · 9 nine · 10 ten · 11 eleven · 12 twelve · 13 thirteen · 14 fourteen · 15 fifteen · 16 sixteen · 17 seventeen · 18 eighteen · 19 nineteen · 20 twenty

A useful first exchange

A: Hello. What is your name?
B: My name is Maya.
A: How do you spell it?
B: M-A-Y-A.

Say your name and spell it. Count five objects near you. Write five numbers in words.

Everyday language

Repeat, notice and use

Colours

red · blue · green · yellow · orange · purple · black · white

My bag is blue. The apple is red. The chair is black.

Days of the week

Monday · Tuesday · Wednesday · Thursday · Friday · Saturday · Sunday

Use a capital letter for days. Say: Today is Monday. I study on Tuesday.

First classroom phrases

Please. / Thank you. / Excuse me. / Sorry.
I do not understand.
Could you repeat that, please?
What does this word mean?

Try it

1. Name three colours you can see.
2. Say the days in order.
3. Write: Today is ...
4. Ask a partner to repeat a word politely.

Hello, world

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Names & introductions

01 / Read and notice

Hello! My name is Maya. I am a student. I am from Canada. This is my friend, Leo. He is from Italy. We are in an English class. Our teacher is Anna. She is kind.

Language focus

Use I am, you are, he/she is and we/they are. In conversation: I'm Maya. She's Anna. Ask: What is your name? Where are you from?

Key words

name - a word people call you

friend - a person you like and know

student - a person who learns

kind - helpful and caring

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

Hello, world

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

Where is Leo from?

A. Canada / B. Italy / C. England

2. Who teaches the class?

---

3. What do we know about Maya?

---

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: are / is / am / are / is

1. I _____ a student.

2. She _____ from Italy.

3. We _____ in a class.

4. My name _____ Anna.

5. They _____ kind.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

Hello, world

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> Hello. My name is Maya. I am a student.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 20-30 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write 3 sentences about yourself. Include your name, where you are from, and what you do.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

Things around me

LANGUAGE FOCUS / A / an & simple nouns

01 / Read and notice

This is my desk. There is a book on the desk. There is an apple next to the book. My bag is blue. Two pencils are in my bag. That is a chair. The chair is small.

Language focus

Use a before a consonant sound: a book. Use an before a vowel sound: an apple. Add -s for most plurals: one pencil, two pencils. This is near; that is farther away.

Key words

desk - a table for work

apple - a round fruit

pencil - a tool for writing

next to - beside

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

Things around me

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

What is next to the book?

A. A bag / B. A chair / C. An apple

2. Where are the pencils?

3. What is blue?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: pencils / This / is / an / a

1. This is _____ apple.

2. I have _____ book.

3. There are two _____ in my bag.

4. _____ is my desk here.

5. That _____ a chair.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

Things around me

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> This is a book. My bag is blue.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 20-30 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Describe 4 things near you. Use a or an and at least one colour.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

My family

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Possessives & people

01 / Read and notice

I am Ben. My sister is Ella. She is seven years old. Our mother is a doctor. Our father is a cook. His food is good. We have a cat. Its name is Coco. We live in a small house.

Language focus

My belongs to me; your belongs to you; his, her, its, our and their show belonging. Say her name, not she name. Age: She is seven years old.

Key words

sister - a female sibling

mother - a female parent

cook - a person who makes food

house - a building where people live

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

My family

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

Who is a doctor?

A. Ben's mother / B. Ben's father / C. Ella

2. How old is Ella?

3. What is the cat called?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: Its / His / My / our / Her

1. Ella is my sister. _____ name is Ella.

2. Ben is my brother. _____ name is Ben.

3. We have a cat. _____ name is Coco.

4. I am Ben. _____ father is a cook.

5. We live here. This is _____ house.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

My family

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> My sister is Ella. Our mother is a doctor.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 20-30 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write 4 sentences about a real or imaginary family. Use my, his and her.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

A simple day

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Basic verbs & time

01 / Read and notice

I wake up at seven. I eat breakfast at eight. I go to school at nine. I drink water at lunch. After school, I play with my friend. I go home at four. I read a book at night.

Language focus

Use the present simple for a routine: I eat breakfast. Use at with clock times: at seven. Useful order words: first, then, after, finally.

Key words

wake up - stop sleeping

breakfast - the first meal

school - a place to learn

at night - in the dark part of the day

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

A simple day

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

When does the student go home?

A. At seven / B. At four / C. At nine

2. What happens after school?

3. When is breakfast?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: at / eat / to / at / First

1. I wake up _____ seven.

2. _____, I wake up. Then I eat.

3. I _____ breakfast at eight.

4. I go _____ school.

5. I read a book _____ night.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

A simple day

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

I wake up at seven. I eat breakfast at eight.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 20-30 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write your day in 4 short sentences. Include two times.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

Level checkpoint / 1 of 2

Eight questions across meaning and language. Refer to the lesson passages for reading questions.

Choose one answer per question. Pass this practice check with at least 6 out of 8 correct. It is not an official placement or certification test.

01. Where is Leo from?

A. Canada

B. Italy

C. England

Reading reference: Lesson 1, Hello, world

02. Choose the correct sentence.

A. She are a teacher.

B. She is a teacher.

C. She am a teacher.

Language focus review

03. What is next to the book?

A. A bag

B. A chair

C. An apple

Reading reference: Lesson 2, Things around me

04. Choose the correct phrase.

A. an apple

B. a apple

C. apple an

Language focus review

Level checkpoint / 2 of 2

Eight questions across meaning and language. Refer to the lesson passages for reading questions.

Choose one answer per question. Pass this practice check with at least 6 out of 8 correct. It is not an official placement or certification test.

05. Who is a doctor?

A. Ben's mother

B. Ben's father

C. Ella

Reading reference: Lesson 3, My family

06. Complete: This is Ella. ___ name is Ella.

A. His

B. She

C. Her

Language focus review

07. When does the student go home?

A. At seven

B. At four

C. At nine

Reading reference: Lesson 4, A simple day

08. Complete: I wake up ___ seven.

A. in

B. at

C. on

Language focus review

Answer key / 1 of 2

Check after trying. Alternative wording is acceptable in open answers.

Lesson 1 / Hello, world

Reading 1: B. Italy. The text says "He is from Italy." He refers to Leo.

Reading 2: Anna teaches the class.

Reading 3: She is a student from Canada.

Language practice: 1. am; 2. is; 3. are; 4. is; 5. are

Dictation: Hello!

Lesson 2 / Things around me

Reading 1: C. An apple. An apple is next to the book. "Next to" tells us where something is.

Reading 2: They are in the bag.

Reading 3: The bag is blue.

Language practice: 1. an; 2. a; 3. pencils; 4. This; 5. is

Dictation: This is my desk.

Checkpoint answers

1. B: The text says "He is from Italy." He refers to Leo.
2. B: He and she take is.
3. C: An apple is next to the book. "Next to" tells us where something is.
4. A: Apple starts with a vowel sound.

Answer key / 2 of 2

Check after trying. Alternative wording is acceptable in open answers.

Lesson 3 / My family

Reading 1: A. Ben's mother. "Our mother is a doctor." Our refers to Ben and Ella.

Reading 2: She is seven.

Reading 3: Its name is Coco.

Language practice: 1. Her; 2. His; 3. Its; 4. My; 5. our

Dictation: I am Ben.

Lesson 4 / A simple day

Reading 1: B. At four. The sentence "I go home at four" gives the answer.

Reading 2: The student plays with a friend.

Reading 3: At eight.

Language practice: 1. at; 2. First; 3. eat; 4. to; 5. at

Dictation: I wake up at seven.

Checkpoint answers

5. A: "Our mother is a doctor." Our refers to Ben and Ella.
6. C: Her is the possessive form for she.

7. B: The sentence "I go home at four" gives the answer.
8. B: Use at with a clock time.

Review and continue

Use evidence of practice, not just a score.

Writing review

There is no single correct response to a personal writing prompt. Use this four-part review and ask a teacher or partner for feedback when possible.

Task - My response answers the prompt and gives relevant examples.

Language - I attempted the target structure and checked verb forms and word order.

Organisation - Ideas follow a clear order. At higher levels, claims have support and qualifications.

Revision - I improved one sentence after rereading or receiving feedback.

Speaking review

Focus on intelligibility, appropriate vocabulary, complete ideas and natural pauses. At Starter, short clear phrases are enough. At Advanced, support a position, respond to alternatives and choose an appropriate register.

After your checkpoint

6-8 correct: continue if the productive tasks also feel manageable.
0-5 correct: revisit the language explanations and try new examples before retaking the check.

A strong multiple-choice score alone does not demonstrate writing or speaking proficiency. Keep a portfolio of drafts and recordings.

Next step: Elementary - Talk about routines, people, places and everyday needs.

English Orbit

PART 2 OF 6 / A1

Elementary

Talk about routines, people, places and everyday needs.

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Your route through this part

Talk about routines, people, places and everyday needs.

Four lessons, one clear sequence

01 Everyday rhythms | Present simple & frequency

02 At the café | Countable & uncountable nouns

03 Finding your way | There is / are & directions

04 What is happening? | Present continuous

How to study a lesson

1. Read for the overall meaning. Read again and notice the language focus.
2. Learn the four key words. Make your own example for each word.
3. Complete the reading and grammar practice before checking the answers.
4. Listen without reading first. Write a dictation, then compare it with the script.
5. Speak aloud, record if possible, and reflect on your delivery.
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Everyday rhythms

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Present simple & frequency

01 / Read and notice

Nora works in a library. She starts at nine and finishes at five. She usually walks to work, but on rainy days she takes the bus. She does not work on Sundays. In the evening, she often reads or cooks dinner.

Language focus

With he/she/it add -s: she works. Negatives: I don't work; she doesn't work. After doesn't, use the base verb. Frequency adverbs usually go before a main verb: she often reads.

Key words

usually - most of the time

library - a place with books to borrow

rainy - with rain

finish - complete or end

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

Everyday rhythms

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

How does Nora travel on rainy days?

A. She walks / B. She takes the bus / C. She rides a bike

2. What hours does Nora work?

3. Which day does she not work?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: do not / reads / works / takes / does not

1. Nora _____ in a library.

2. She _____ work on Sundays.

3. On rainy days she _____ the bus.

4. I _____ work on Sundays.

5. She often _____ in the evening.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

Everyday rhythms

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> She usually walks to work, but today she takes the bus.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 20-30 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Describe your weekly routine in 5 sentences. Use usually, often and don't.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

At the café

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Countable & uncountable nouns

01 / Read and notice

Customer: I would like a sandwich and some tea, please. Server: Would you like milk in your tea? Customer: Yes, a little milk, but no sugar. Server: We have cheese or chicken sandwiches. Customer: A cheese sandwich, please. How much is it? Server: Six pounds in total.

Language focus

Countable: a sandwich, two sandwiches. Uncountable: tea, milk, sugar. Use some with both: some tea, some sandwiches. Ask how much for a price or an uncountable amount.

Key words

sandwich - food between slices of bread

sugar - a sweet ingredient

a little - a small amount

in total - all together

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

At the café

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

What does the customer want in the tea?

A. Sugar only / B. A little milk / C. Milk and sugar

2. Which sandwich does the customer choose?

3. What is the total price?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: a / some / much / little / sandwiches

1. I would like _____ sandwich.

2. Can I have _____ tea?

3. I want a _____ milk.

4. How _____ is it?

5. There are two _____ on the plate.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

At the café

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> I would like a cheese sandwich and some tea, please.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 20-30 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write a short café dialogue with 4 lines. Order food, a drink and ask the price.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

Finding your way

LANGUAGE FOCUS / There is / are & directions

01 / Read and notice

There is a museum opposite the station. There are two cafés next to the museum. To reach the park, walk straight along King Street. Turn left at the bank. The park is on your right, behind the supermarket. It is a quiet place to sit.

Language focus

Use there is for one thing; there are for more than one. Directions use base verbs: walk, turn, go. Opposite means across from; behind means at the back of.

Key words

opposite - across from

straight - without turning

bank - a place for money services

behind - at the back of

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

Finding your way

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

Where do you turn left?

A. At the museum / B. At the supermarket / C. At the bank

2. Where is the museum?

3. How many cafés are next to it?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: behind / left / are / is / straight

1. There _____ a museum.

2. There _____ two cafés.

3. Turn _____ at the bank.

4. The park is _____ the supermarket.

5. Walk _____ along King Street.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

Finding your way

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> Walk straight along King Street. Turn left at the bank.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 20-30 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Give directions from an imaginary station to a park. Use straight, left and right.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

What is happening?

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Present continuous

01 / Read and notice

It is Saturday afternoon. Sam is painting a picture in the garden. His parents are preparing lunch. His sister is not helping; she is talking to a friend on the phone. The dog is sleeping under a tree. Everyone is enjoying the sunshine.

Language focus

Use am/is/are + verb-ing for an action happening now: Sam is painting. Negative: she isn't helping. Compare a routine, I paint on Saturdays, with now, I'm painting.

Key words

prepare - make something ready

paint - make a picture with colours

under - below

sunshine - light from the sun

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

What is happening?

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

What is Sam's sister doing?

A. Preparing lunch / B. Talking on the phone / C. Painting

2. Where is Sam?

---

3. Who is preparing lunch?

---

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: is enjoying / is painting / is sleeping / are preparing / is not helping

1. Sam _____ a picture now.

2. His parents _____ lunch.

3. His sister _____ now.

4. The dog _____ under a tree.

5. Everyone _____ the sunshine.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

What is happening?

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> Sam is painting. His parents are preparing lunch.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 20-30 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Describe what 4 people are doing now. Use is/are + an -ing verb.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

Level checkpoint / 1 of 2

Eight questions across meaning and language. Refer to the lesson passages for reading questions.

Choose one answer per question. Pass this practice check with at least 6 out of 8 correct. It is not an official placement or certification test.

01. How does Nora travel on rainy days?

A. She walks

B. She takes the bus

C. She rides a bike

Reading reference: Lesson 1, Everyday rhythms

02. Choose the correct negative.

A. She doesn't works.

B. She don't work.

C. She doesn't work.

Language focus review

03. What does the customer want in the tea?

A. Sugar only

B. A little milk

C. Milk and sugar

Reading reference: Lesson 2, At the café

04. Which phrase is correct?

A. a little milk

B. a milk

C. many milk

Language focus review

Level checkpoint / 2 of 2

Eight questions across meaning and language. Refer to the lesson passages for reading questions.

Choose one answer per question. Pass this practice check with at least 6 out of 8 correct. It is not an official placement or certification test.

05. Where do you turn left?

A. At the museum

B. At the supermarket

C. At the bank

Reading reference: Lesson 3, Finding your way

06. Complete: There ___ two cafés.

A. is

B. are

C. am

Language focus review

07. What is Sam's sister doing?

A. Preparing lunch

B. Talking on the phone

C. Painting

Reading reference: Lesson 4, What is happening?

08. Choose the action happening now.

A. He paint now.

B. He is painting now.

C. He painting now.

Language focus review

Answer key / 1 of 2

Check after trying. Alternative wording is acceptable in open answers.

Lesson 1 / Everyday rhythms

Reading 1: B. She takes the bus. The contrast after "but" explains how rainy days change her routine.

Reading 2: From nine until five.

Reading 3: Sunday.

Language practice: 1. works; 2. does not; 3. takes; 4. do not; 5. reads

Dictation: Nora works in a library.

Lesson 2 / At the café

Reading 1: B. A little milk. The customer asks for a little milk and explicitly says no sugar.

Reading 2: A cheese sandwich.

Reading 3: Six pounds.

Language practice: 1. a; 2. some; 3. little; 4. much; 5. sandwiches

Dictation: Customer: I would like a sandwich and some tea, please.

Checkpoint answers

1. B: The contrast after "but" explains how rainy days change her routine.
2. C: After doesn't, use the base verb.
3. B: The customer asks for a little milk and explicitly says no sugar.
4. A: Milk is uncountable.

Answer key / 2 of 2

Check after trying. Alternative wording is acceptable in open answers.

Lesson 3 / Finding your way

Reading 1: C. At the bank. You turn left at the bank, then find the park on your right.

Reading 2: Opposite the station.

Reading 3: Two.

Language practice: 1. is; 2. are; 3. left; 4. behind; 5. straight

Dictation: There is a museum opposite the station.

Lesson 4 / What is happening?

Reading 1: B. Talking on the phone. "She is talking to a friend on the phone" describes her current action.

Reading 2: In the garden.

Reading 3: His parents.

Language practice: 1. is painting; 2. are preparing; 3. is not helping; 4. is sleeping; 5. is enjoying

Dictation: It is Saturday afternoon.

Checkpoint answers

5. C: You turn left at the bank, then find the park on your right.
6. B: Use are with a plural noun.

7. B: "She is talking to a friend on the phone" describes her current action.
8. B: Present continuous uses is + -ing.

Review and continue

Use evidence of practice, not just a score.

Writing review

There is no single correct response to a personal writing prompt. Use this four-part review and ask a teacher or partner for feedback when possible.

Task - My response answers the prompt and gives relevant examples.

Language - I attempted the target structure and checked verb forms and word order.

Organisation - Ideas follow a clear order. At higher levels, claims have support and qualifications.

Revision - I improved one sentence after rereading or receiving feedback.

Speaking review

Focus on intelligibility, appropriate vocabulary, complete ideas and natural pauses. At Starter, short clear phrases are enough. At Advanced, support a position, respond to alternatives and choose an appropriate register.

After your checkpoint

6-8 correct: continue if the productive tasks also feel manageable.
0-5 correct: revisit the language explanations and try new examples before retaking the check.

A strong multiple-choice score alone does not demonstrate writing or speaking proficiency. Keep a portfolio of drafts and recordings.

Next step: Pre-intermediate - Tell stories, make plans and handle everyday situations.

English Orbit

PART 3 OF 6 / A2

Pre-intermediate

Tell stories, make plans and handle everyday situations.

Read. Listen. Write. Speak. Understand.

An original coursebook companion to the interactive English Orbit course. Four connected lessons combine language explanations with practical activities and guided review.

Included in this part: language focus, vocabulary, reading passages, grammar practice, listening scripts, speaking tasks, writing tasks, a level checkpoint and answer keys.

For independent learners, classrooms and teacher-led study. All teaching content is in English.

Use the course alongside the book

Open English Orbit to hear lesson passages and model sentences. Select this level and the matching lesson.

CEFR labels indicate the intended language focus. This compact companion is not a complete CEFR syllabus or an official proficiency qualification.

Your route through this part

Tell stories, make plans and handle everyday situations.

Four lessons, one clear sequence

01 A weekend to remember | Past simple

02 Plans and possibilities | Going to & will

03 Choosing a place to stay | Comparatives & superlatives

04 Healthy habits | Should & everyday advice

How to study a lesson

1. Read for the overall meaning. Read again and notice the language focus.
2. Learn the four key words. Make your own example for each word.
3. Complete the reading and grammar practice before checking the answers.
4. Listen without reading first. Write a dictation, then compare it with the script.
5. Speak aloud, record if possible, and reflect on your delivery.
6. Write a response, review it and revise at least one sentence.

> Suggested rhythm: 25-40 minutes in the app, plus 20-30 minutes of book practice per lesson. Take breaks and repeat difficult activities rather than rushing to the next level.

Use a notebook for extended answers. Listening can use the app, a teacher or a study partner. The PDF contains scripts and tasks; it does not contain embedded audio.

For open questions, wording may differ from the sample answers. For speaking and writing, use the review criteria; there is no single correct personal response.

A weekend to remember

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Past simple

01 / Read and notice

Last weekend, I visited my cousin in Brighton. We took a train to the coast and walked along the beach. The weather was cold, so we bought hot chocolate. I lost my ticket, but my cousin found it in my coat. We returned home after sunset.

Language focus

Regular past verbs add -ed: visited, walked. Irregular forms must be learned: take to took, buy to bought, find to found. Questions: Did you visit? Negatives: I didn't visit. Use the base verb after did.

Key words

coast - land beside the sea

ticket - proof you can travel or enter

coat - a warm outer garment

sunset - when the sun disappears

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

A weekend to remember

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

Why did they buy hot chocolate?

A. They missed the train / B. The weather was cold / C. They lost a ticket

2. Who found the lost ticket?

3. When did they return home?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: found / visited / did not take / bought / took

1. Last weekend I _____ my cousin.

2. We _____ a train.

3. We _____ hot chocolate.

4. My cousin _____ the ticket.

5. We _____ a bus.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

A weekend to remember

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> We took a train to the coast and walked along the beach.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 45-60 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write 60-80 words about a past outing. Include where, when, what happened and how you felt.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

Plans and possibilities

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Going to & will

01 / Read and notice

Mina is going to start a photography course next month. She has already paid for it. She thinks it will help her find creative work. This weekend, she is going to buy a camera. Her brother says, "I'll come with you and help you choose."

Language focus

Use going to for a plan made earlier: I'm going to study. Use will for a prediction or an immediate decision: I think it will help. I'll help you. Both forms depend on the speaker's purpose.

Key words

photography - making pictures with a camera

creative - using imagination

choose - select

already - before now

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

Plans and possibilities

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

Which action is already planned?

A. Her brother choosing a course / B. Mina starting a photography course / C. Mina teaching photography

2. What evidence shows the course is a prior plan?

3. What does her brother offer?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: is going to study / is going to start / will help / will come / are going to buy

1. She _____ a course next month: she has paid.

2. I think it _____ her.

3. A decision now: I _____ with you.

4. We _____ a camera: that is our plan.

5. He _____ tonight: he planned it yesterday.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

Plans and possibilities

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> I am going to start a course. I think it will help me.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 45-60 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write 60-80 words about your next month. Include two plans with going to and one prediction with will.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

Choosing a place to stay

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Comparatives & superlatives

01 / Read and notice

The River Hotel is cheaper than the Central Hotel, but it is farther from the station. The Central Hotel has larger rooms and the fastest internet. The River Hotel is quieter. We chose the River Hotel because a good night's sleep mattered more to us than a large room.

Language focus

Short adjectives: cheap to cheaper to the cheapest. Longer adjectives: comfortable to more comfortable to the most comfortable. Irregular: good to better to best. Use than for comparisons.

Key words

farther - at a greater distance

quiet - with little noise

matter - be important

room - a space inside a building

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

Choosing a place to stay

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

Why did they choose the River Hotel?

A. It had the fastest internet / B. It was closest to the station / C. It was quieter

2. Which hotel has larger rooms?

---

3. What trade-off do they accept?

---

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: quieter / fastest / larger / cheaper / better

1. The River Hotel is _____ than the Central Hotel.

2. The Central Hotel has _____ rooms.

3. It has the _____ internet.

4. The River Hotel is _____.

5. Good becomes _____ in the comparative.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

Choosing a place to stay

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> The River Hotel is cheaper, but the Central Hotel has larger rooms.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 45-60 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Compare two places in 60-80 words. Include three comparisons and explain your choice.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

Healthy habits

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Should & everyday advice

01 / Read and notice

Arun feels tired because he sleeps only five hours a night. His friend suggests a regular bedtime. "You should stop using your phone before bed," she says. "You shouldn't drink coffee late in the evening." Arun decides to try these changes for a week and see how he feels.

Language focus

Use should + base verb to give advice: You should rest. Use shouldn't for advice against something. Should is a recommendation, not a strict rule. Must expresses stronger obligation.

Key words

habit - something you do regularly

bedtime - the time you go to bed

suggest - offer an idea

regular - happening in a consistent pattern

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

Healthy habits

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

What does the friend advise against?

A. Sleeping regularly / B. Drinking coffee late / C. Trying changes

2. How long will Arun try the changes?

3. What causes his tiredness in the passage?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: base / should / should not / recommendation / rest

1. You _____ keep a regular bedtime.

2. You _____ drink coffee late.

3. After should, use the _____ verb.

4. You should _____, not resting.

5. Advice is a _____, not a strict rule.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

Healthy habits

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> You should have a regular bedtime. You should not drink coffee late.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 45-60 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write 60-80 words of advice to a friend who wants a better study routine. Use should and shouldn't.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

Level checkpoint / 1 of 2

Eight questions across meaning and language. Refer to the lesson passages for reading questions.

Choose one answer per question. Pass this practice check with at least 6 out of 8 correct. It is not an official placement or certification test.

01. Why did they buy hot chocolate?

A. They missed the train

B. The weather was cold

C. They lost a ticket

Reading reference: Lesson 1, A weekend to remember

02. Complete: Yesterday we ___ a train.

A. take

B. took

C. taking

Language focus review

03. Which action is already planned?

A. Her brother choosing a course

B. Mina starting a photography course

C. Mina teaching photography

Reading reference: Lesson 2, Plans and possibilities

04. Which expresses a prior plan?

A. I am going to buy a camera.

B. I buyed a camera.

C. I buying a camera.

Language focus review

Level checkpoint / 2 of 2

Eight questions across meaning and language. Refer to the lesson passages for reading questions.

Choose one answer per question. Pass this practice check with at least 6 out of 8 correct. It is not an official placement or certification test.

05. Why did they choose the River Hotel?

A. It had the fastest internet

B. It was closest to the station

C. It was quieter

Reading reference: Lesson 3, Choosing a place to stay

06. Complete: This room is ___ than that one.

A. large

B. largest

C. larger

Language focus review

07. What does the friend advise against?

A. Sleeping regularly

B. Drinking coffee late

C. Trying changes

Reading reference: Lesson 4, Healthy habits

08. Which gives advice?

A. You should to rest.

B. You should rest.

C. You should resting.

Language focus review

Answer key / 1 of 2

Check after trying. Alternative wording is acceptable in open answers.

Lesson 1 / A weekend to remember

Reading 1: B. The weather was cold. The word "so" connects the cold weather to buying a hot drink.

Reading 2: The cousin found it.

Reading 3: After sunset.

Language practice: 1. visited; 2. took; 3. bought; 4. found; 5. did not take

Dictation: Last weekend, I visited my cousin in Brighton.

Lesson 2 / Plans and possibilities

Reading 1: B. Mina starting a photography course. Mina has paid already, so starting the course is a prior plan.

Reading 2: Mina has already paid for it.

Reading 3: To come with her and help her choose a camera.

Language practice: 1. is going to start; 2. will help; 3. will come; 4. are going to buy; 5. is going to study

Dictation: Mina is going to start a photography course next month.

Checkpoint answers

1. B: The word "so" connects the cold weather to buying a hot drink.
2. B: Took is the past form of take.
3. B: Mina has paid already, so starting the course is a prior plan.
4. A: Going to expresses an earlier plan.

Answer key / 2 of 2

Check after trying. Alternative wording is acceptable in open answers.

Lesson 3 / Choosing a place to stay

Reading 1: C. It was quieter. They valued sleep, so quietness was the deciding factor.

Reading 2: The Central Hotel.

Reading 3: They accept smaller rooms and a less central location for quietness.

Language practice: 1. cheaper; 2. larger; 3. fastest; 4. quieter; 5. better

Dictation: The River Hotel is cheaper than the Central Hotel, but it is farther from the station.

Lesson 4 / Healthy habits

Reading 1: B. Drinking coffee late. "You shouldn't drink coffee late" is advice to avoid that action.

Reading 2: One week.

Reading 3: Sleeping only five hours a night.

Language practice: 1. should; 2. should not; 3. base; 4. rest; 5. recommendation

Dictation: Arun feels tired because he sleeps only five hours a night.

Checkpoint answers

5. C: They valued sleep, so quietness was the deciding factor.
6. C: Use the comparative larger with than.

7. B: "You shouldn't drink coffee late" is advice to avoid that action.
8. B: Should is followed by a base verb.

Review and continue

Use evidence of practice, not just a score.

Writing review

There is no single correct response to a personal writing prompt. Use this four-part review and ask a teacher or partner for feedback when possible.

Task - My response answers the prompt and gives relevant examples.

Language - I attempted the target structure and checked verb forms and word order.

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Speaking review

Focus on intelligibility, appropriate vocabulary, complete ideas and natural pauses. At Starter, short clear phrases are enough. At Advanced, support a position, respond to alternatives and choose an appropriate register.

After your checkpoint

6-8 correct: continue if the productive tasks also feel manageable.
0-5 correct: revisit the language explanations and try new examples before retaking the check.

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Next step: Intermediate - Explain experiences, solve problems and give reasons.

English Orbit

PART 4 OF 6 / B1

Intermediate

Explain experiences, solve problems and give reasons.

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Your route through this part

Explain experiences, solve problems and give reasons.

Four lessons, one clear sequence

01 Experiences that change us | Present perfect vs past simple

02 If we make a change | First & second conditionals

03 How things are made | Passive voice

04 A problem worth solving | Reported speech

How to study a lesson

1. Read for the overall meaning. Read again and notice the language focus.
2. Learn the four key words. Make your own example for each word.
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Experiences that change us

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Present perfect vs past simple

01 / Read and notice

I have volunteered at a community garden for two years. I joined in 2024, when a neighbour invited me. Since then, I have learned how to grow vegetables and work in a team. Last Saturday, we organised our first open day. More than fifty visitors came, and several signed up to help.

Language focus

Present perfect: have/has + past participle, for experiences or a period continuing now. Past simple describes a finished time: I joined in 2024. For gives duration; since gives a starting point.

Key words

volunteer - work without pay to help

community - people in a shared place

sign up - register

neighbour - a person living nearby

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

Experiences that change us

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

Which event has a specific finished time?

A. Learning teamwork / B. Volunteering for two years / C. Organising the open day last Saturday

2. How did the writer join the garden?

3. What happened after the open day?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: have volunteered / joined / organised / since / for

1. I _____ here for two years and still do.

2. I _____ in 2024.

3. I have worked here _____ 2024.

4. I have worked here _____ two years.

5. Last Saturday we _____ an open day.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

Experiences that change us

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> I have volunteered for two years. I joined when a neighbour invited me.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 45-60 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write 100-120 words about something you have learned. Use present perfect for experience and past simple for one event.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

If we make a change

LANGUAGE FOCUS / First & second conditionals

01 / Read and notice

Our town has too much traffic. If the council improves bus services, more people will leave their cars at home. However, change may be slow. If I were the mayor, I would create safer cycle lanes too. These ideas require money, but they could make everyday travel easier.

Language focus

First conditional: if + present, will + base verb, for a possible future. Second: if + past, would + base verb, for an imagined situation. If I were is a common formal pattern.

Key words

council - local governing group

mayor - leader of a town or city

cycle lane - a path for bicycles

require - need

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

If we make a change

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

Which idea is presented as an imagined role?

A. The council improving buses / B. The writer being mayor / C. People leaving cars at home

2. What change is proposed in addition to better buses?

3. What practical limitation is acknowledged?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: would create / will leave / had / possible / save

1. If the council improves buses, more people _____ cars at home.

2. If I were mayor, I _____ cycle lanes.

3. If we _____ money, we will buy new books.

4. If I _____ more time, I would volunteer.

5. The first conditional describes a _____ future.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

If we make a change

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> If the council improves buses, more people will leave their cars at home.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 45-60 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write 100-120 words proposing a change at school or work. Use both a realistic and an imagined conditional.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

How things are made

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Passive voice

01 / Read and notice

The notebooks sold in our shop are made from recycled paper. The paper is collected from local offices and sorted by workers. It is then cleaned and pressed into new sheets. Last year, the packaging was redesigned to use less plastic. Customers are given information about the production process.

Language focus

Passive: be + past participle. Present: paper is collected. Past: packaging was redesigned. Use it when the action or result matters more than the doer. Add by when the doer is relevant.

Key words

recycled - processed for use again

sort - put into groups

sheet - a thin flat piece

packaging - material around a product

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

How things are made

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

Why is the passive useful in this text?

A. It focuses on the process / B. It hides the time of every event / C. It makes all actions future

2. How did the packaging change?

3. Where does the recycled paper come from?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: is collected / are pressed / is given / was redesigned / is collected

1. The paper _____ every week.

2. Last year the packaging _____.

3. The sheets _____ into shape.

4. Information _____ to customers.

5. Workers collect paper. Passive: Paper _____ by workers.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

How things are made

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> The paper is collected, cleaned and pressed into new sheets.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 45-60 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Explain a familiar process in 100-120 words. Include three passive structures and sequence words.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

A problem worth solving

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Reported speech

01 / Read and notice

During the meeting, Lena said that the team needed more time. Omar explained that two files were missing. The manager asked whether they could finish by Friday. Lena replied that they would send a revised schedule that afternoon. Everyone agreed to share updates daily until the work was complete.

Language focus

Reported speech conveys a message without quoting it. After a past reporting verb, tenses often shift: need to needed; will to would. Reported yes/no questions use if or whether, with statement word order.

Key words

revised - changed or updated

schedule - a plan with times

reply - answer

daily - every day

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

A problem worth solving

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

What did Lena promise?

A. To finish immediately / B. To send a revised schedule / C. To cancel the meeting

2. Why did the team need a revised schedule?

3. How often will they share updates?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: statement / whether / would send / needed / were

1. Lena said the team _____ more time.

2. Omar explained that files _____ missing.

3. They said they _____ a schedule.

4. The manager asked _____ they could finish.

5. Reported questions use _____ word order.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

A problem worth solving

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> Lena said that the team needed more time.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 45-60 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write a 100-120 word summary of an imaginary meeting. Report two statements and one question.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

Level checkpoint / 1 of 2

Eight questions across meaning and language. Refer to the lesson passages for reading questions.

Choose one answer per question. Pass this practice check with at least 6 out of 8 correct. It is not an official placement or certification test.

01. Which event has a specific finished time?

A. Learning teamwork

B. Volunteering for two years

C. Organising the open day last Saturday

Reading reference: Lesson 1, Experiences that change us

02. Choose the sentence with a finished past time.

A. I have joined yesterday.

B. I joined yesterday.

C. I joining yesterday.

Language focus review

03. Which idea is presented as an imagined role?

A. The council improving buses

B. The writer being mayor

C. People leaving cars at home

Reading reference: Lesson 2, If we make a change

04. Complete: If I were mayor, I ___ improve cycle lanes.

A. would

B. will

C. am

Language focus review

Level checkpoint / 2 of 2

Eight questions across meaning and language. Refer to the lesson passages for reading questions.

Choose one answer per question. Pass this practice check with at least 6 out of 8 correct. It is not an official placement or certification test.

05. Why is the passive useful in this text?

A. It focuses on the process

B. It hides the time of every event

C. It makes all actions future

Reading reference: Lesson 3, How things are made

06. Choose the passive sentence.

A. Workers collect paper.

B. Paper collects workers.

C. Paper is collected by workers.

Language focus review

07. What did Lena promise?

A. To finish immediately

B. To send a revised schedule

C. To cancel the meeting

Reading reference: Lesson 4, A problem worth solving

08. Report: "We will send a schedule."

A. They said they will sent a schedule.

B. They said they would send a schedule.

C. They said would they send a schedule.

Language focus review

Answer key / 1 of 2

Check after trying. Alternative wording is acceptable in open answers.

Lesson 1 / Experiences that change us

Reading 1: C. Organising the open day last Saturday. "Last Saturday" marks a finished past time, so the text uses the past simple.

Reading 2: A neighbour invited the writer.

Reading 3: Several visitors signed up to help.

Language practice: 1. have volunteered; 2. joined; 3. since; 4. for; 5. organised

Dictation: I have volunteered at a community garden for two years.

Lesson 2 / If we make a change

Reading 1: B. The writer being mayor. "If I were the mayor" imagines a role the writer does not currently have.

Reading 2: Safer cycle lanes.

Reading 3: The ideas require money and change may be slow.

Language practice: 1. will leave; 2. would create; 3. save; 4. had; 5. possible

Dictation: Our town has too much traffic.

Checkpoint answers

1. C: "Last Saturday" marks a finished past time, so the text uses the past simple.
2. B: Yesterday requires the past simple here.

3. B: "If I were the mayor" imagines a role the writer does not currently have.
4. A: Imagined situations use would in the result clause.

Answer key / 2 of 2

Check after trying. Alternative wording is acceptable in open answers.

Lesson 3 / How things are made

Reading 1: A. It focuses on the process. The main topic is how notebooks are produced, not the identities of individual workers.

Reading 2: It was redesigned to use less plastic.

Reading 3: Local offices.

Language practice: 1. is collected; 2. was redesigned; 3. are pressed; 4. is given; 5. is collected

Dictation: The notebooks sold in our shop are made from recycled paper.

Lesson 4 / A problem worth solving

Reading 1: B. To send a revised schedule. Lena replied that they would send a revised schedule that afternoon.

Reading 2: They needed more time and two files were missing.

Reading 3: Daily until the work is complete.

Language practice: 1. needed; 2. were; 3. would send; 4. whether; 5. statement

Dictation: During the meeting, Lena said that the team needed more time.

Checkpoint answers

5. A: The main topic is how notebooks are produced, not the identities of individual workers.
6. C: Passive uses be + past participle.

7. B: Lena replied that they would send a revised schedule that afternoon.
8. B: Will typically shifts to would after a past reporting verb.

Review and continue

Use evidence of practice, not just a score.

Writing review

There is no single correct response to a personal writing prompt. Use this four-part review and ask a teacher or partner for feedback when possible.

Task - My response answers the prompt and gives relevant examples.

Language - I attempted the target structure and checked verb forms and word order.

Organisation - Ideas follow a clear order. At higher levels, claims have support and qualifications.

Revision - I improved one sentence after rereading or receiving feedback.

Speaking review

Focus on intelligibility, appropriate vocabulary, complete ideas and natural pauses. At Starter, short clear phrases are enough. At Advanced, support a position, respond to alternatives and choose an appropriate register.

After your checkpoint

6-8 correct: continue if the productive tasks also feel manageable.
0-5 correct: revisit the language explanations and try new examples before retaking the check.

A strong multiple-choice score alone does not demonstrate writing or speaking proficiency. Keep a portfolio of drafts and recordings.

Next step: Upper-intermediate - Discuss ideas, weigh evidence and express nuanced opinions.

English Orbit

PART 5 OF 6 / B2

Upper-intermediate

Discuss ideas, weigh evidence and express nuanced opinions.

Read. Listen. Write. Speak. Understand.

An original coursebook companion to the interactive English Orbit course. Four connected lessons combine language explanations with practical activities and guided review.

Included in this part: language focus, vocabulary, reading passages, grammar practice, listening scripts, speaking tasks, writing tasks, a level checkpoint and answer keys.

For independent learners, classrooms and teacher-led study. All teaching content is in English.

Use the course alongside the book

Open English Orbit to hear lesson passages and model sentences. Select this level and the matching lesson.

CEFR labels indicate the intended language focus. This compact companion is not a complete CEFR syllabus or an official proficiency qualification.

Your route through this part

Discuss ideas, weigh evidence and express nuanced opinions.

Four lessons, one clear sequence

01 The attention economy | Argument & contrast

02 A different outcome | Third conditional & reflection

03 Evidence or impression? | Hedging & evaluating claims

04 Negotiating a solution | Polite disagreement & proposals

How to study a lesson

1. Read for the overall meaning. Read again and notice the language focus.
2. Learn the four key words. Make your own example for each word.
3. Complete the reading and grammar practice before checking the answers.
4. Listen without reading first. Write a dictation, then compare it with the script.
5. Speak aloud, record if possible, and reflect on your delivery.
6. Write a response, review it and revise at least one sentence.

> Suggested rhythm: 25-40 minutes in the app, plus 20-30 minutes of book practice per lesson. Take breaks and repeat difficult activities rather than rushing to the next level.

Use a notebook for extended answers. Listening can use the app, a teacher or a study partner. The PDF contains scripts and tasks; it does not contain embedded audio.

For open questions, wording may differ from the sample answers. For speaking and writing, use the review criteria; there is no single correct personal response.

The attention economy

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Argument & contrast

01 / Read and notice

Digital platforms compete for our attention. Notifications can help us stay informed, yet they also interrupt deep work. Some researchers argue that switching between tasks carries a hidden cost: we need time to regain focus. Nevertheless, removing every notification is not always practical. A more balanced approach is to decide which messages deserve immediate attention and check the rest at planned intervals.

Language focus

Use contrast markers precisely: yet introduces a contrast; nevertheless acknowledges a difficulty while continuing an argument. Distinguish a claim from the supporting reason. The recommendation is a compromise, not a complete ban.

Key words

regain - get back

interval - a period between events

selectively - by choosing some rather than all

interrupt - stop something briefly

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

The attention economy

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

Which position best matches the writer's view?

A. All notifications should be removed / B. Every message needs an immediate response / C. Manage notifications selectively

2. What is the hidden cost of switching tasks?

---

3. Why does the writer reject a complete ban?

---

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: yet / intervals / Nevertheless / regain / balanced

1. Notifications help, _____ they interrupt work.

2. _____, removing every notification is impractical.

3. The recommendation is a _____ approach.

4. We need time to _____ focus.

5. Check non-urgent messages at planned _____.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

The attention economy

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> Although notifications can be useful, they may interrupt deep work.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 60-90 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write 150-180 words arguing for a practical way to manage digital distractions. Address one counterargument.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

A different outcome

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Third conditional & reflection

01 / Read and notice

The organisers expected three hundred guests, but nearly five hundred arrived. As a result, the food ran out early. If they had checked registrations more carefully, they would have ordered enough. They could also have arranged a backup supplier. Rather than blame individuals, the team agreed to improve its planning process before the next event.

Language focus

Third conditional: if + had + past participle, would have + past participle. It imagines a different past. Could have describes a past possibility. Reflection can identify improvements without assigning personal blame.

Key words

registration - a record of signing up

supplier - a provider of goods

backup - an alternative for emergencies

blame - hold responsible for a mistake

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

A different outcome

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

What is implied about registration checks?

A. They were sufficiently careful / B. They could have been more careful / C. They were impossible

2. How many guests arrived compared with the estimate?

3. What did the team decide to improve?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: had checked / have arranged / would have ordered / ran out / past

1. If they _____ registrations, they would have ordered more.

2. They _____ more if they had checked.

3. They could _____ a backup supplier.

4. The food _____ before everyone ate.

5. The third conditional imagines a different _____.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

A different outcome

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> If they had checked registrations, they would have ordered enough food.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 60-90 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write 150-180 words reflecting on a past decision, real or fictional. Include two unreal past alternatives and a future lesson.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

Evidence or impression?

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Hedging & evaluating claims

01 / Read and notice

A small survey found that employees who worked from home reported greater satisfaction. This may suggest a benefit, but the result should be interpreted cautiously. Participants chose to answer the survey, and most worked in technology. The findings therefore cannot automatically be applied to every profession. A larger, more representative study would help clarify the relationship.

Language focus

Hedging avoids claiming more than evidence supports: may suggest, appears to, is likely to. Evaluate sample size, selection and representativeness. A reported association does not by itself establish causation.

Key words

representative - reflecting the wider group

finding - a research result

cautiously - with care

association - a relationship between things

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

Evidence or impression?

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

What limits the survey's generalisability?

A. Its participants were not representative of every profession / B. It included no employees / C. It measured nothing

2. Why might the sample be biased?

3. What kind of study would help?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: causation / technology / representative / may suggest / cautiously

1. The results _____ a benefit, not prove it.

2. Interpret the findings _____.

3. The sample was not _____ of every profession.

4. An association does not establish _____.

5. Most participants worked in _____.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

Evidence or impression?

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> The findings may suggest a benefit, but they should be interpreted cautiously.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 60-90 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write 150-180 words evaluating a fictional survey. Include two limitations and carefully qualified conclusions.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

Negotiating a solution

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Polite disagreement & proposals

01 / Read and notice

A client wants the new website delivered a week early. The designer explains that this would leave too little time for testing. "I understand why the date matters," she says. "Would you be open to launching the core pages first?" The client agrees, provided that the remaining pages follow within two weeks. Both sides confirm the revised scope in writing.

Language focus

Acknowledge a concern before presenting an alternative. Would you be open to + -ing is a tactful proposal. Provided that introduces a condition. Confirm scope and timing to avoid ambiguous agreements.

Key words

scope - the agreed extent of work

provided that - only if

core - most essential

tactful - careful about others' feelings

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

Negotiating a solution

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

What compromise do they reach?

A. Cancel the website / B. Launch the core pages before the remaining pages / C. Skip all testing

2. Why is an early launch difficult?

3. When must the remaining pages follow?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: provided that / acknowledges / scope / only if / launching

1. Would you be open to _____ the core pages first?

2. The client agrees _____ other pages follow.

3. Both sides confirm the revised _____.

4. The designer _____ why the date matters.

5. Provided that means _____.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

Negotiating a solution

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> Would you be open to launching the core pages first?

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 60-90 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write a 150-180 word professional email negotiating a deadline. Acknowledge the request, propose an alternative and specify conditions.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

Level checkpoint / 1 of 2

Eight questions across meaning and language. Refer to the lesson passages for reading questions.

Choose one answer per question. Pass this practice check with at least 6 out of 8 correct. It is not an official placement or certification test.

01. Which position best matches the writer's view?

A. All notifications should be removed

B. Every message needs an immediate response

C. Manage notifications selectively

Reading reference: Lesson 1, The attention economy

02. Which introduces a contrast?

A. Therefore

B. Nevertheless

C. As a result

Language focus review

03. What is implied about registration checks?

A. They were sufficiently careful

B. They could have been more careful

C. They were impossible

Reading reference: Lesson 2, A different outcome

04. Complete: If they had checked, they ___ enough food.

A. would have ordered

B. will order

C. would ordered

Language focus review

Level checkpoint / 2 of 2

Eight questions across meaning and language. Refer to the lesson passages for reading questions.

Choose one answer per question. Pass this practice check with at least 6 out of 8 correct. It is not an official placement or certification test.

05. What limits the survey's generalisability?

A. Its participants were not representative of every profession

B. It included no employees

C. It measured nothing

Reading reference: Lesson 3, Evidence or impression?

06. Which is appropriately cautious?

A. This proves everyone benefits.

B. Every profession must benefit.

C. This may suggest a benefit.

Language focus review

07. What compromise do they reach?

A. Cancel the website

B. Launch the core pages before the remaining pages

C. Skip all testing

Reading reference: Lesson 4, Negotiating a solution

08. "Provided that" means…

A. because

B. only if

C. even though

Language focus review

Answer key / 1 of 2

Check after trying. Alternative wording is acceptable in open answers.

Lesson 1 / The attention economy

Reading 1: C. Manage notifications selectively. The writer recognises their usefulness, then recommends prioritising messages and checking others at intervals.

Reading 2: Time needed to regain focus.

Reading 3: Removing every notification is not always practical.

Language practice: 1. yet; 2. Nevertheless; 3. balanced; 4. regain; 5. intervals

Dictation: Digital platforms compete for our attention.

Lesson 2 / A different outcome

Reading 1: B. They could have been more careful. The unreal past condition suggests the checks were not careful enough in reality.

Reading 2: Nearly 500 arrived; 300 were expected.

Reading 3: Its planning process rather than blaming individuals.

Language practice: 1. had checked; 2. would have ordered; 3. have arranged; 4. ran out; 5. past

Dictation: The organisers expected three hundred guests, but nearly five hundred arrived.

Checkpoint answers

1. C: The writer recognises their usefulness, then recommends prioritising messages and checking others at intervals.
2. B: Nevertheless introduces a contrasting point despite the previous one.

3. B: The unreal past condition suggests the checks were not careful enough in reality.
4. A: The third conditional uses would have + past participle.

Answer key / 2 of 2

Check after trying. Alternative wording is acceptable in open answers.

Lesson 3 / Evidence or impression?

Reading 1: A. Its participants were not representative of every profession. Most respondents worked in technology and chose to respond, so the sample may not reflect other professions.

Reading 2: People chose to respond, and most worked in technology.

Reading 3: A larger and more representative study.

Language practice: 1. may suggest; 2. cautiously; 3. representative; 4. causation; 5. technology

Dictation: A small survey found that employees who worked from home reported greater satisfaction.

Lesson 4 / Negotiating a solution

Reading 1: B. Launch the core pages before the remaining pages. They agree to a staged launch with the remaining pages following within two weeks.

Reading 2: It leaves too little time for testing.

Reading 3: Within two weeks.

Language practice: 1. launching; 2. provided that; 3. scope; 4. acknowledges; 5. only if

Dictation: A client wants the new website delivered a week early.

Checkpoint answers

5. A: Most respondents worked in technology and chose to respond, so the sample may not reflect other professions.
6. C: May suggest qualifies the conclusion.

7. B: They agree to a staged launch with the remaining pages following within two weeks.
8. B: Provided that introduces a condition.

Review and continue

Use evidence of practice, not just a score.

Writing review

There is no single correct response to a personal writing prompt. Use this four-part review and ask a teacher or partner for feedback when possible.

Task - My response answers the prompt and gives relevant examples.

Language - I attempted the target structure and checked verb forms and word order.

Organisation - Ideas follow a clear order. At higher levels, claims have support and qualifications.

Revision - I improved one sentence after rereading or receiving feedback.

Speaking review

Focus on intelligibility, appropriate vocabulary, complete ideas and natural pauses. At Starter, short clear phrases are enough. At Advanced, support a position, respond to alternatives and choose an appropriate register.

After your checkpoint

6-8 correct: continue if the productive tasks also feel manageable.
0-5 correct: revisit the language explanations and try new examples before retaking the check.

A strong multiple-choice score alone does not demonstrate writing or speaking proficiency. Keep a portfolio of drafts and recordings.

Next step: Advanced - Interpret complex arguments and communicate with precision.

English Orbit

PART 6 OF 6 / C1

Advanced

Interpret complex arguments and communicate with precision.

Read. Listen. Write. Speak. Understand.

An original coursebook companion to the interactive English Orbit course. Four connected lessons combine language explanations with practical activities and guided review.

Included in this part: language focus, vocabulary, reading passages, grammar practice, listening scripts, speaking tasks, writing tasks, a level checkpoint and answer keys.

For independent learners, classrooms and teacher-led study. All teaching content is in English.

Use the course alongside the book

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CEFR labels indicate the intended language focus. This compact companion is not a complete CEFR syllabus or an official proficiency qualification.

Your route through this part

Interpret complex arguments and communicate with precision.

Four lessons, one clear sequence

01 Reading between the lines | Inference & rhetorical framing

02 Precision in academic writing | Nominalisation & cohesion

03 A nuanced position | Concession & synthesis

04 Speaking with authority | Register & persuasive structure

How to study a lesson

1. Read for the overall meaning. Read again and notice the language focus.
2. Learn the four key words. Make your own example for each word.
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4. Listen without reading first. Write a dictation, then compare it with the script.
5. Speak aloud, record if possible, and reflect on your delivery.
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Reading between the lines

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Inference & rhetorical framing

01 / Read and notice

The city's new square is described as a gift to residents. Yet its polished benches have dividers, its cafés charge premium prices, and gathering after dark is discouraged. The space is undeniably attractive; the question is who can comfortably use it. Public design, the writer suggests, should be judged not merely by appearance but by the forms of everyday life it permits.

Language focus

Inference must be grounded in details. The positive description followed by restrictive features creates a tension. Not merely X but Y shifts the criterion of judgement. Evaluate what is implied without claiming certainty beyond the text.

Key words

rhetorical - related to persuasive language

premium - higher than standard

permit - allow

inclusive - welcoming different groups

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

Reading between the lines

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

What concern does the writer imply?

A. The square may exclude some residents despite looking attractive / B. The square has no benches / C. All residents dislike beautiful spaces

2. Which details create tension with the phrase gift to residents?

---

3. What criterion replaces appearance alone?

---

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: inclusiveness / merely / contrast / evidence / restrict

1. Public design should be judged not _____ by appearance.

2. Premium prices may _____ access.

3. An inference must be grounded in _____.

4. The word yet introduces a _____.

5. The concern is practical _____.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

Reading between the lines

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> A public space should be judged not merely by appearance but by the life it permits.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 60-90 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write 220-260 words analysing how a public space can be inclusive or exclusive. Use concrete evidence and distinguish inference from fact.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

Precision in academic writing

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Nominalisation & cohesion

01 / Read and notice

The introduction of flexible working has prompted a reassessment of office culture. Its success depends not simply on location but on the clarity of expectations. Where communication is inconsistent, flexibility may amplify existing problems. Conversely, a deliberate investment in shared practices can strengthen trust. Treating flexibility as a universal remedy therefore obscures the organisational conditions that make it effective.

Language focus

Nominalisation turns actions into nouns: introduce to introduction; reassess to reassessment. It can connect complex ideas, but overuse makes prose heavy. Cohesion requires clear references: its refers to flexible working. Conversely signals a contrasting case.

Key words

reassessment - a new evaluation

amplify - make stronger

remedy - a solution

obscure - make harder to see

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

Precision in academic writing

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

What is the central claim?

A. Flexible working always solves organisational problems / B. Office location is the only important factor / C. Flexible working works well under appropriate organisational conditions

2. When might flexibility amplify problems?

3. What can strengthen trust?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: reassessment / amplify / Conversely / remedy / flexible working

1. The noun from reassess is _____.

2. In the text, its refers to _____.

3. _____ introduces a contrasting case.

4. Flexible work is not a universal _____.

5. Inconsistent communication may _____ problems.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

Precision in academic writing

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> Its success depends on the clarity of expectations and shared practices.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 60-90 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write a 220-260 word analytical paragraph on flexible study or work. Use cohesive references and avoid unsupported universal claims.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

A nuanced position

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Concession & synthesis

01 / Read and notice

Supporters of automated decision systems point to consistency and speed. Critics counter that consistency can reproduce unfairness when the underlying data reflects past discrimination. Both observations can be valid. The useful distinction is not between human and machine decisions in the abstract, but between accountable and unaccountable processes. Whatever the method, people affected by a decision should be able to understand its basis and challenge it.

Language focus

A concession accepts a valid opposing point without abandoning a position. Synthesis integrates perspectives into a new criterion. Whatever the method means regardless of the method. Look for the principle that reconciles the competing arguments.

Key words

accountable - answerable for actions

underlying - forming the basis

discrimination - unfair unequal treatment

synthesis - combining ideas into a whole

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

A nuanced position

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

Which principle reconciles the views?

A. Speed should override every other concern / B. Decisions need explanation and routes for challenge / C. Human decisions are always fair

2. How can consistency reproduce unfairness?

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3. What rights should affected people have?

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03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: challenge / accountability / regardless of / integrates / valid

1. Whatever the method means _____ the method.

2. Both observations can be _____.

3. Affected people should be able to _____ decisions.

4. The shared criterion is _____.

5. A synthesis _____ perspectives.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

A nuanced position

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> Whatever the method, people should be able to understand and challenge a decision.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 60-90 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write 220-260 words synthesising two opposing views on automated decisions. End with a justified criterion for responsible use.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

Speaking with authority

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Register & persuasive structure

01 / Read and notice

Thank you for considering this proposal. Our aim is not to promise instant transformation, but to establish a workable first step. A six-week pilot would allow us to test assumptions, identify difficulties and gather feedback before committing further resources. Should the results fall short, we would revise the approach. If they are encouraging, expansion could proceed gradually, with clear milestones and independent review.

Language focus

Register is language suited to an audience and situation. Should the results fall short is formal conditional inversion: If the results should fall short. A persuasive proposal states purpose, method, safeguards and evaluation rather than relying on exaggerated promises.

Key words

pilot - a small trial before expansion

milestone - a significant stage

fall short - fail to meet expectations

safeguard - a protective measure

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

Speaking with authority

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

How does the speaker build credibility?

A. By promising instant success / B. By avoiding evaluation / C. By proposing a limited pilot with review and revision

2. Why use a limited pilot?

3. What happens if results are encouraging?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: exaggerated / pilot / revise / if / milestones

1. Should the results fall short means _____ the results should fall short.

2. A six-week _____ tests assumptions.

3. Clear _____ mark stages of progress.

4. If results disappoint, the team would _____ the approach.

5. Credibility comes from testable plans rather than _____ promises.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

Speaking with authority

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> Should the results fall short, we would revise the approach.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 60-90 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write a 220-260 word proposal for a learning initiative. Include a pilot, evaluation criteria and a plan for an unsuccessful result.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

Level checkpoint / 1 of 2

Eight questions across meaning and language. Refer to the lesson passages for reading questions.

Choose one answer per question. Pass this practice check with at least 6 out of 8 correct. It is not an official placement or certification test.

01. What concern does the writer imply?

A. The square may exclude some residents despite looking attractive

B. The square has no benches

C. All residents dislike beautiful spaces

Reading reference: Lesson 1, Reading between the lines

02. Which is an inference supported by the passage?

A. Premium prices may restrict who uses the square.

B. No one has ever visited the square.

C. The city has no other public space.

Language focus review

03. What is the central claim?

A. Flexible working always solves organisational problems

B. Office location is the only important factor

C. Flexible working works well under appropriate organisational conditions

Reading reference: Lesson 2, Precision in academic writing

04. Choose a nominalisation of "reassess".

A. reassessed

B. reassessment

C. reassessing quickly

Language focus review

Level checkpoint / 2 of 2

Eight questions across meaning and language. Refer to the lesson passages for reading questions.

Choose one answer per question. Pass this practice check with at least 6 out of 8 correct. It is not an official placement or certification test.

05. Which principle reconciles the views?

A. Speed should override every other concern

B. Decisions need explanation and routes for challenge

C. Human decisions are always fair

Reading reference: Lesson 3, A nuanced position

06. "Whatever the method" means…

A. Only this method

B. Regardless of the method

C. Because of the method

Language focus review

07. How does the speaker build credibility?

A. By promising instant success

B. By avoiding evaluation

C. By proposing a limited pilot with review and revision

Reading reference: Lesson 4, Speaking with authority

08. Rewrite: "Should the results fall short…"

A. Because results always fail…

B. When results have already failed…

C. If the results should fall short…

Language focus review

Answer key / 1 of 2

Check after trying. Alternative wording is acceptable in open answers.

Lesson 1 / Reading between the lines

Reading 1: A. The square may exclude some residents despite looking attractive. Dividers, high prices and discouraged gatherings support a concern about practical inclusiveness.

Reading 2: Divided benches, premium café prices and discouraged gatherings after dark.

Reading 3: The kinds of everyday life that the space allows.

Language practice: 1. merely; 2. restrict; 3. evidence; 4. contrast; 5. inclusiveness

Dictation: The city's new square is described as a gift to residents.

Lesson 2 / Precision in academic writing

Reading 1: C. Flexible working works well under appropriate organisational conditions. The passage emphasises expectations, communication and shared practices rather than treating flexibility as a universal remedy.

Reading 2: When communication is inconsistent.

Reading 3: Deliberate investment in shared practices.

Language practice: 1. reassessment; 2. flexible working; 3. Conversely; 4. remedy; 5. amplify

Dictation: The introduction of flexible working has prompted a reassessment of office culture.

Checkpoint answers

1. A: Dividers, high prices and discouraged gatherings support a concern about practical inclusiveness.
2. A: The price detail supports a cautious inference about access.

3. C: The passage emphasises expectations, communication and shared practices rather than treating flexibility as a universal remedy.
4. B: Reassessment is a noun derived from reassess.

Answer key / 2 of 2

Check after trying. Alternative wording is acceptable in open answers.

Lesson 3 / A nuanced position

Reading 1: B. Decisions need explanation and routes for challenge. Accountability is the shared criterion: affected people should understand and be able to challenge decisions.

Reading 2: When underlying data reflects past discrimination.

Reading 3: To understand the basis of decisions and challenge them.

Language practice: 1. regardless of; 2. valid; 3. challenge; 4. accountability; 5. integrates

Dictation: Supporters of automated decision systems point to consistency and speed.

Lesson 4 / Speaking with authority

Reading 1: C. By proposing a limited pilot with review and revision. A pilot, feedback, milestones and independent review make the proposal testable and accountable.

Reading 2: To test assumptions, identify problems and gather feedback before further investment.

Reading 3: Expansion may proceed gradually with milestones and independent review.

Language practice: 1. if; 2. pilot; 3. milestones; 4. revise; 5. exaggerated

Dictation: Thank you for considering this proposal.

Checkpoint answers

5. B: Accountability is the shared criterion: affected people should understand and be able to challenge decisions.
6. B: Whatever broadens the principle to any method.

7. C: A pilot, feedback, milestones and independent review make the proposal testable and accountable.
8. C: Should inversion expresses a formal condition.

Review and continue

Use evidence of practice, not just a score.

Writing review

There is no single correct response to a personal writing prompt. Use this four-part review and ask a teacher or partner for feedback when possible.

Task - My response answers the prompt and gives relevant examples.

Language - I attempted the target structure and checked verb forms and word order.

Organisation - Ideas follow a clear order. At higher levels, claims have support and qualifications.

Revision - I improved one sentence after rereading or receiving feedback.

Speaking review

Focus on intelligibility, appropriate vocabulary, complete ideas and natural pauses. At Starter, short clear phrases are enough. At Advanced, support a position, respond to alternatives and choose an appropriate register.

After your checkpoint

6-8 correct: continue if the productive tasks also feel manageable.
0-5 correct: revisit the language explanations and try new examples before retaking the check.

A strong multiple-choice score alone does not demonstrate writing or speaking proficiency. Keep a portfolio of drafts and recordings.

Next step: Revisit difficult lessons. Extend your learning with authentic reading, listening and teacher feedback.